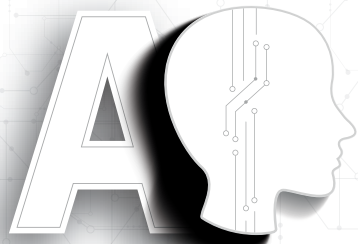


**TikTok ban delayed in US**

A U.S. federal court has delayed the ban on TikTok while the court considers the ban's legality. <http://digit.in/oct20-13>

**YouTube for news**

A study found that roughly 26% of Americans get their news from YouTube. <http://digit.in/oct20-14>



AI-driven Indian startups

Dhriti Datta | dhriti@digit.in

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here's no doubt that AI (Artificial Intelligence) is one of the most, if not the most, disruptive technology

that has emerged in the past century. The technology has been at the forefront of driving digital transformation in the enterprise. Therefore, it's no surprise that startups in India are increasingly leveraging AI to build solutions or uplift their business to greater heights. The growth of AI-powered startups has been staggering over the past few years, with a recent report stating that a staggering \$87.85 million was raised in the AI space alone in India's startup capital, Bengaluru. According to AIMResearch, Indian AI and Analytics startups attracted investment worth \$762.5 million in 2019, which was a sizable 44 percent increase over the \$530 million funding received in 2018. Owing to this spectacular growth, India has emerged as a country with a robust startup ecosystem that uses cutting-edge technology to provide solutions.

AI TAKES OFF IN THE INDIAN STARTUP ECOSYSTEM

Startups that are aspiring to inculcate AI into their businesses to further

Meet Indian startups that leverage AI to create utilitarian solutions

elevate their solutions can benefit from the freely-available research papers on AI online, as well as knowledge sharing on Github. Open-source programming platforms by Google (Tensorflow), Facebook (Pytorch) and others also help accelerate the use of AI tools. Additionally, there's no dearth of online application-oriented courses from websites such as Coursera, Udemy, Udacity, and Upgrad. The Indian IT industry has already exhibited its dominance in the AI era from the services point of view, however, we still are playing catch up when it comes to product development, where we occupy a much smaller percentage of the pie.

To encourage and grow our dominance in this area as well, challenges and competitions serve as healthy

instigators to progress. To that end, an AI Challenge for Indian startups in the field of AI is being organised by the Ministry of Electronics and Information Technology (MeitY) to promote and showcase innovative AI solutions developed by Indian entrepreneurs. The program is being promoted by both, the MeitY Startup Hub as well as the Atal Innovation Mission, NITI Aayog. Fifteen selected AI startups will be chosen for an AI Showcase on October 6. In this challenge, the winners will be awarded a sum of ₹20 lakh each for their innovations.

In a similar vein, Western Digital recently concluded its flagship startup challenge, Data Innovation Bazaar 2020 which was hosted in partnership with Invest India and Startup India, and other partners such as MeitY, Department of Science and Technology - Ministry of Science and Technology, and The Indus Entrepreneurs (TiE Delhi-NCR). The startup challenge was a platform for data-driven solutions in industries such as smart transportation, smart cities, agriculture, healthcare, education, and others. In this competition, the top five startups were awarded a total amount of ₹25 lakhs. Challenges such as these not only provide these nascent startups with much-needed funds, but also drive them to implement AI tools into their businesses.

AI-DRIVEN INDIAN STARTUPS

According to Tracxn, there are 2,024 AI startups in India, as of April 2020. These startups cover a large number of sectors such as ecommerce, fintech, banking, agriculture, surveillance, big data, analytics, customer service, and more. The AI rage continues unabated



AI Challenge organised by MeitY and NITI Aayog to showcase AI solutions